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WHAT THE HECK DOES THIS MEAN?

The stupidity of democracy. It will always remain one of democracy's best jokes that it provided its deadly enemies with the means by which it was destroyed. The persecuted leaders of the NSDAP became parliamentary deputies and so acquired the use of parliamentary immunity, allowances and free travel tickets. They were thus protected from police interference, could allow themselves to say more than the ordinary citizen, and apart from that they also had the costs of their activity paid by their enemy. One can make superb capital from democratic stupidity. The members of the NSDAP grasped that right away and took enormous pleasure in it.¹²⁵

(NSDAP = Nazi Party)

Yay Democracy?

1923 – a failed coup d'état (Munich Putsch or 'Beer Hall' putsch)
imprisoned for nine months – writes Mein Kampf
realizes he must gain power legitimately

After the stock market crash (1929), **the economic crisis leads more people to listen to Hitler's solutions**



By 1933, the **Nazi have the most seats in the Reichstag, and Hitler is named Chancellor**

A month later, the Reichstag burned down.
Nazis claim it was the work of the communists
(Reichstag Fire Decree = suspend civil liberties)

Hitler has President Hindenburg sign the “Enabling Act”

